



COUNTY PUBLIC SERVICE BOARD NATIONAL CONSULTATIVE FORUM

DCollect
USER MANUAL

County Public Service Salary and Remuneration Survey Platform

Implemented by BINSTOPEJ Management Solutions Ltd

Version 2.0 · August 2026 · Confidential

Field	Detail
Document title	DCollect User Manual (PDF)
Audience	Administrators, collection staff, consultants, analysts and county respondents
Classification	Confidential — for authorised survey users only
Applies to	DCollect web application for the 2026 CPSB-NCF review
How to obtain	Platform administrator: left menu → User manual (PDF)

This manual describes how to sign in, configure the survey, complete a county file, review submissions, download collected data and analyse market position. Menu names match the live application. Figures illustrate typical screens; wording on a live site may differ slightly by role and period.

Information entered in DCollect is confidential and is used solely for the Salary and Remuneration Review. Institution-level data that is commercially or administratively sensitive may be reported in aggregated form.

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1. Purpose of DCollect

DCollect is the field collection and analysis application for the County Public Service Salary and Remuneration Review commissioned by the County Public Service Board National Consultative Forum (CPSB-NCF) and undertaken by BINSTOPEJ Management Solutions Ltd. It captures **one institutional file per County Government** for the active survey period, together with supporting documents, optional individual staff responses, and comparator organisation pay. It then produces market position tables and Excel extracts.

1.1 What the platform does

- Opens a county file for the active survey period.
- Collects the institutional questionnaire (sections A–J), job-group pay, the benefits matrix and uploads.
- Packs a file after submit, and reopens only the modules named in a clarification.
- Records consultant validation and an activity history on each file.
- Collects comparator organisation pay on the same job catalogue.
- Accepts staff survey forms through a unique link, tagged to a county.
- Calculates county and market percentiles (P25 / P50 / P75) and issues workbooks and a complete county zip.

1.2 Confidentiality

Respondent name, designation, telephone and email on the institutional questionnaire are for the consultant's use only. Staff survey name and email are optional. Uploaded files are not public: they are downloaded from the county file after sign-in. Do not circulate passwords, staff survey links beyond the intended audience, or county packs outside the review team.

2. Roles and left-hand menu

Sign in with the account issued to you. The left-hand menu shows only the work for that role. If a page is missing, it is not part of your role.

Role	Fresh-install login	Principal work
Administrator	admin	Owens site identity, audit trail and data reset. Can do everything else as well.
Collection administrator	admin2	Periods, catalogues, forms, users and county files. Cannot open the audit trail or reset all data.
Field consultant	consultant	Reviews files, validation, clarifications and comparators.
Analyst	analyst	Analysis and Reports. Does not fill or certify county files.
County respondent	created under Users	Completes one county's file. Cannot open another county.

Table 1. Roles. Change starter passwords at first sign-in. Default password on a fresh install is *ChangeMe!2026* unless *BOOTSTRAP_PASSWORD* is set.

2.1 What each person sees in the left menu

Menu item	Who sees it	Opens
Dashboard	Everyone	Greeting, next step, counts and shortcuts.
My county file / Clarifications	County respondent	That county's file only.
County files / Questionnaires	Admin, collection admin, consultant, analyst	Files in the active period.
Staff survey links	Admin, collection admin	Public and per-county staff form URLs.
Comparators / Analysis / Reports	Admin, collection admin, consultant, analyst	Market input and outputs.
Variables & settings, Forms & questions, Users	Admin, collection admin	Setup.
Audit trail / Data administration / User manual (PDF)	Platform administrator only	Who did what, destructive tools, this manual.
What I need to do	Everyone except collection administrator	Short in-app checklist.
Change password / Sign out	Everyone	Account security.

Table 2. Navigation. Collection administrators do not see Audit trail, Data administration or the PDF manual.

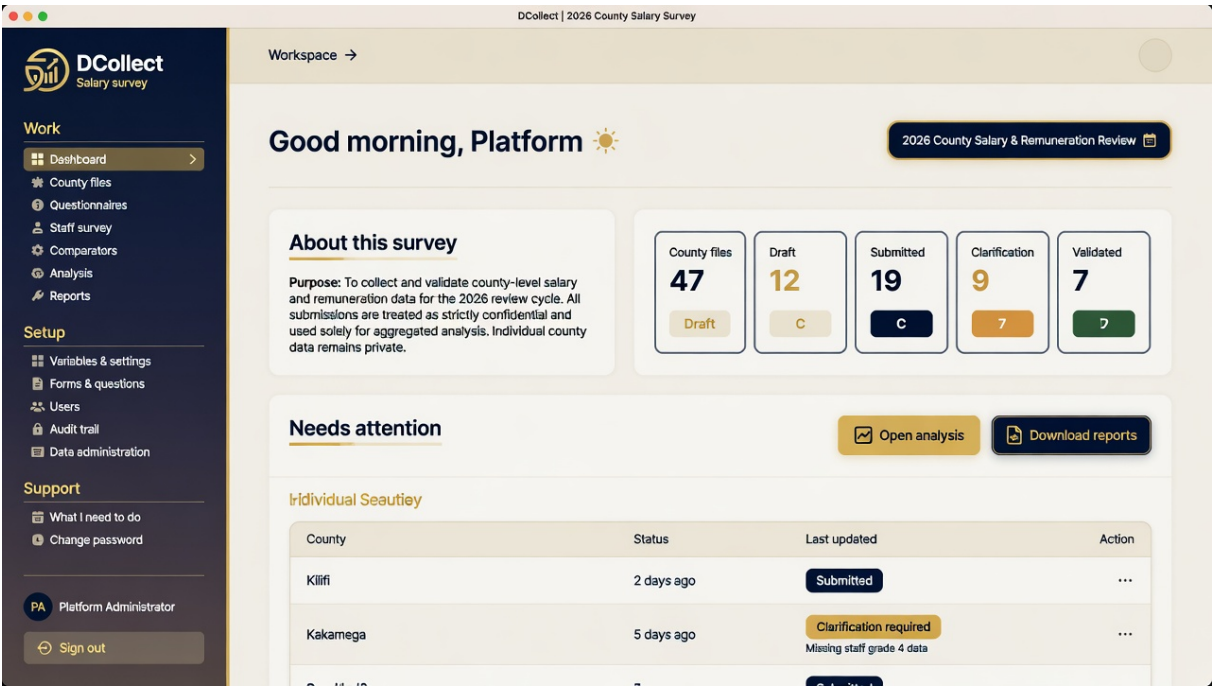


Figure 1. Administrator dashboard and left-hand menu (illustrative layout).

3. Signing in and moving around

3.1 Sign in

- 1 Open the survey address in a browser (local test: http://127.0.0.1:8000/).
- 2 Enter the username and password issued to you, then choose **Enter workspace**.
- 3 If the account must change password, DCollect opens Change password first. The new password must be at least 10 characters.
- 4 Use **Change password** at any later time from the bottom of the left menu.
- 5 Choose **Sign out** when you finish. The session also ends after **10 minutes without activity**. You will see a notice on the sign-in page. Idle sign-out is written to the audit trail.

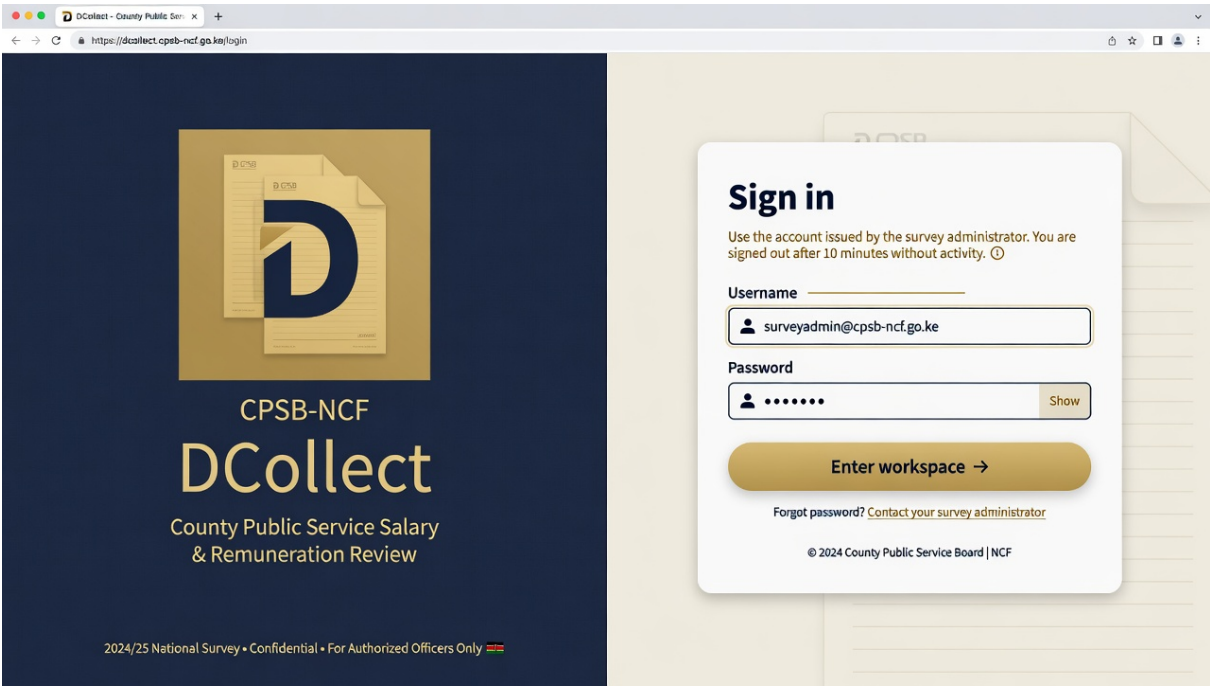


Figure 2. Sign-in screen. After idle sign-out the same page explains that you must sign in again.

3.2 Screen layout

- bullet **Left menu** — role-specific links. On a small screen, use Menu.
- bullet **Top bar** — breadcrumb, page title, and the active survey period.
- bullet **Main area** — the work for that page.
- bullet **Gold buttons** — the primary action (Save, Submit, Download complete file). Ghost buttons are secondary.

3.3 Inside a county file

Open a file from Dashboard, County files, or My county file. A horizontal file menu is always available at the top of the file:

Tab	Purpose
Overview	Status, progress, assignment, certify / submit / validate / return, activity.
Questionnaire	Institutional form, sections A–J. Save each section.
Jobs	Pay by job group A–U (excluding I and O).
Benefits	Provided? Interest charged? Eligibility and comments.

Tab	Purpose
Documents	Uploads. Several files per heading. Optional items may be Not available.
Certify	Name, designation, initials. Date is stored automatically.
Clarifications	Reviewer questions and county answers.
Individual responses	Staff who used the county survey link.
Validation	Consultant quality checklist (reviewers only).

Table 3. County file tabs.

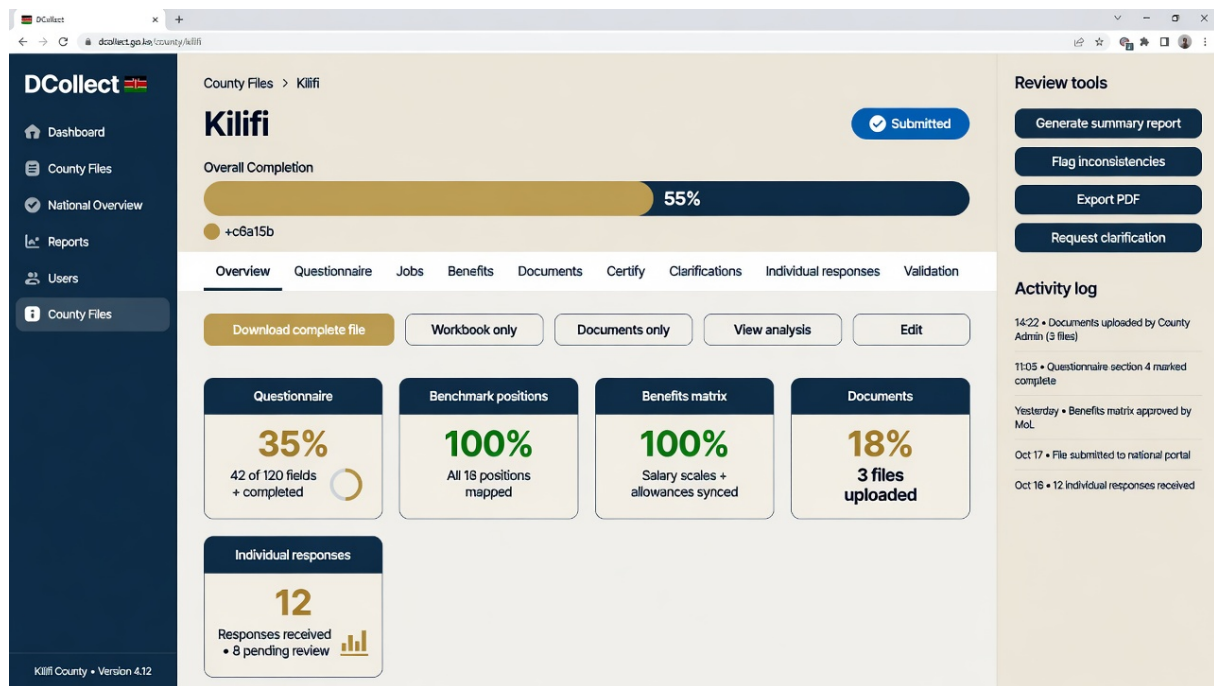


Figure 3. County file Overview: progress cards, file tabs, and Download complete file.

4. County respondent — completing a file

You work only on your county. Keep the approved salary structure and the allowance and benefits schedules beside you. Amounts are Kenya shillings, monthly, without thousands separators in number fields.

4.1 Order of work

- 1 **Dashboard** → **Open file** (or **My county file**). If a Next step box is showing, start there.
- 2 **Questionnaire** — sections A to J. Save a section before leaving it (**Save this section** or **Save and continue**).
- 3 **Jobs** — one row per job group A–U excluding I and O. Mark N/A if the county does not use that group. Enter SRC equivalent as free text (for example EX4), then min basic, max basic, house, commuter, airtime and Total of Other Allowances.
- 4 **Benefits** — Provided? Yes / No / Partial; Interest charged? Yes / No on every row (leave blank if interest does not apply); eligibility; comments.
- 5 **Documents** — upload the file or files for each heading. A required heading needs at least one file. Optional headings may be ticked Not available. Several files are allowed under one heading (for example more than one salary structure).
- 6 **Certify** — name, designation, initials.
- 7 **Overview** → **Submit for review**. After submit you cannot edit until a reviewer returns the file.
- 8 If **Clarifications** appear, answer each one, correct only the unlocked section(s), certify if needed, and submit again.

4.2 Progress percentages

Overview percentages measure **what has actually been filled or uploaded**. An empty file shows 0%, not 100%. Questionnaire counts answered questions. Jobs count a row when it is N/A or when both min and max basic are entered. Benefits count a row when Provided? is answered (and Interest charged? when the benefit is a loan-type item marked Yes or Partial). Documents count a heading when a file is present, or when an optional heading is marked Not available. Items marked Required still control whether you can submit; optional blanks do not inflate the percentage.

4.3 After submit

The file is locked. You can still read it. On Overview use **Download complete file** for one zip that contains the county workbook and every uploaded document in folders. **Workbook only** is the Excel pack. **Documents only** is the attachments zip. These copies of your own file are not the market comparison.

5. Questionnaire sections A–J

Complete **one questionnaire per County Government**. County name and survey period are filled from the file and cannot be edited on the form. Extra questions added by the administrator appear in the section they were placed in.

Figure 4. Questionnaire — section pills A–J and Section E (allowances and medical cover).

5.1 Navigation

- 1 Open the county file → **Questionnaire**.
- 2 Use the section pills A–J at the top. A green outline means that section is fully answered.
- 3 Complete the fields. Dropdowns include a blank “Select” until you choose.
- 4 Choose **Save this section** to stay, or **Save and continue** to move to the next section.

5.2 What each section asks

Section	Content
A Institution	Department; respondent name, designation, telephone, email (consultant use only).
B Workforce	Permanent & pensionable, contract, casual, other. Total is calculated. Use 0 if none.
C Policy	Approved policy; philosophy defined; market position; last review year; triggers.
D Structure	Number of grades; progression factors (If Other, specify); paid above maximum and why.
E Allowances	Remunerative and non-remunerative allowances; expenditure; medical insurance and how cover is arranged (SHA, private, mixed, self-funded, reimbursement, combination, other); medical cost; pension %; gratuity %; other benefits.
F Recruitment	Recruitment challenges (free text); hard-to-recruit and hard-to-retain families; reasons; benchmarking frequency; usual comparators.
G Equity	Internal equity (equal pay for work of equal value); significant pay differences and causes if Yes.
H Pay mix	Basic %, allowances %, other cash % (should add to 100); progression method; years in grade; placement factors.
I Affordability	Personnel % of budget; can the county accommodate about 15%; implementation approach and period; priority categories and why.

Section	Content
J Observations	Whether listed schedules are attached (upload on Documents); three challenges; three recommendations; other comments.

Table 4. Questionnaire map.

6. Jobs, benefits and documents

6.1 Jobs (benchmark positions)

- 1 County file → **Jobs**.
- 2 For each job group A–U excluding I and O: either tick **N/A**, or enter SRC equivalent, min basic, max basic, house, commuter, airtime and Total of Other Allowances.
- 3 SRC equivalent is free text (for example Job Group S may be EX4). There is no median or headcount column.
- 4 Choose **Save positions**.

Analysis uses the midpoint of min and max. A leftover payroll median is used only if both min and max are blank. A row counts as complete for progress only when it is N/A or when both min and max are filled.

Job group	N/A	SRC equivalent e.g. EX4	Min basic	Max basic	House	Commuter	Airtime	Total of Other Allowances
A	☐	EX4	KES 42,350	KES 58,920	KES 18,500	KES 6,800	KES 3,200	KES 12,450
B	☐	EX5	KES 51,800	KES 71,400	KES 22,000	KES 7,500	KES 3,500	KES 14,200
C	☐	SG7	KES 63,250	KES 89,100	KES 26,300	KES 8,900	KES 4,100	KES 17,650
D	☒	SG9						
E	☐	SG11	KES 78,900	KES 112,300	KES 31,000	KES 10,200	KES 4,800	KES 21,300
F	☐	EX8	KES 94,500	KES 134,800	KES 36,700	KES 12,100	KES 5,500	KES 24,800
G	☐	SG13	KES 108,200	KES 149,600	KES 41,200	KES 13,400	KES 6,000	KES 27,900
H	☒	SG15						

Save positions ✓

Figure 5. Jobs table — SRC equivalent, min/max basic and allowances. N/A marks unused groups.

6.2 Benefits matrix

- 1 County file → **Benefits**.
- 2 For each listed benefit set **Provided?** to Yes, No or Partial.
- 3 Set **Interest charged?** Yes or No where it applies (always visible). For car loan and house mortgage, if Provided is Yes or Partial you must also answer Interest charged.
- 4 Add employer/employee contribution, eligibility and comments as known.
- 5 Choose **Save benefits**.

6.3 Documents

- 1 County file → **Documents**.
- 2 Open a heading (for example Current approved salary structure).
- 3 Choose files (several at once if needed) and **Save this section**. Existing files are kept.
- 4 Download any single file, or **Download complete file** for the workbook plus all attachments.
- 5 Optional headings may be marked **Not available** if you do not have the document. A required heading needs at least one file. Marking Received without a file is not accepted.

Typical headings (the administrator can add, hide or mark required): current approved salary structure; staff establishment; job grades and job families; list of positions/designations; allowance schedule; employee benefits schedule; relevant CBA; previous salary survey; pension arrangements; medical insurance arrangements; other relevant remuneration documents.

Document Checklist
Project EMP-3921 • Last updated 11 Oct 2024, 14:32

Upload and manage required supporting documents for payroll verification. Several files can be attached per section. All documents are reviewed by HR within 48 hours.

Current approved salary structure Required* 3 files uploaded • Verified Download documents only

Name	Uploaded	
Salary_Structure_2024_v2.pdf	09 Oct 2024, 09:15	Download Remove
Salary_Scale_Annexure_A.xlsx	08 Oct 2024, 16:40	Download Remove
Approval_Memo_HR_signed.pdf	07 Oct 2024, 11:22	Download Remove

Add files
Drag & drop or click to upload (PDF, XLSX, max 15MB) Browse

Received? Yes - 10 Oct 2024 Comments All scales match union agreement. Minor typo on page 3 corrected.

Staff establishment Optional

No files uploaded yet
☒ **Not available**
(Exemption approved by HR on 05 Oct)

5 of 12 sections completed • Progress 42%

Figure 6. Documents — several files under one heading, Download on each row, Not available on optional items.

7. Submit, clarification and validation

Status	Meaning
Draft	County (or reviewer) can edit all modules.
Submitted	Locked for the county. Waiting for review.
Clarification requested	County can edit only the modules named in open clarifications (and Certify).
Validated	Accepted for analysis. County remains locked.

Table 5. File status.

7.1 County submit

- 1 Complete the modules. Overview percentages should reflect real answers and files.
- 2 Certify if the survey requires it (default on).
- 3 Overview → **Submit for review**. Confirm the completion percentage shown in the prompt.

7.2 Consultant return and validate

- 1 Dashboard → **Needs attention**, or County files filtered to Submitted / Clarification.
- 2 Read questionnaire, jobs, benefits and documents. Open each uploaded file as needed.
- 3 Validation tab — set a status on **every** item. An empty checklist cannot be used to mark the file validated.
- 4 If something must change: Clarifications → name the module → send. That returns the file to the county.
- 5 When the file is in order: Overview → **Mark validated**.

If every open clarification is answered, the county can edit the whole file again until they re-submit.

8. Consultants, comparators and staff links

8.1 Comparators

- 1 Left menu → **Comparators**.
- 2 Open an organisation → **Pay table** and enter min / max / median and allowances for the same benchmark jobs the counties use. Tick N/A where the organisation has no equivalent.
- 3 Open **Benefits** for that organisation.
- 4 Only organisations marked **include in market median** enter Analysis.
- 5 A platform administrator can delete a comparator from its Details page. That removes stored pay and benefits; county files are not touched.

8.2 Staff survey links

- 1 Left menu → **Staff survey links** (administrators and collection administrators).
- 2 Copy the **county-specific** URL and send it to people who work in that county but do not have a DCollect login.
- 3 Each completed form is stored on that county's **Individual responses** tab.
- 4 There is also one open (unscoped) link; prefer the county link so answers are tagged correctly.

Staff enter job title or the closest benchmark job, terms, years in role, and monthly basic plus allowances. Name and email are optional.

9. Analysis and reports

9.1 Live analysis

- 1 Left menu → **Analysis**.
- 2 Pick a county. Switch **Basic** or **Total cash** (basic plus house, commuter, airtime and other).
- 3 Read Official (midpoint of min/max), Staff n, County P25/P50/P75, Market n, Market P25/P50/P75, Ratio, Position and Scale.
- 4 Use **By SRC equivalent** to see groups mapped to the same SRC denotation (for example EX4).
- 5 Download the market workbook, or **Download complete file** for that county.

County P25/P50/P75 combine the official figure with staff forms for that job group. Quartiles need at least two observations; with one figure only P50 is shown. Market percentiles are taken from comparator organisation medians (each organisation counts once). Ratio is county P50 ÷ market P50 (1.00 = at market). Scale uses market P25/P75 when two or more organisations have a figure.

9.2 Reports centre

- 1 Left menu → **Reports**.
- 2 Download a cross-county workbook (progress, questionnaire extract, individual responses, market position, job group pay, benefits, document register).
- 3 In the County packs table choose **Complete file** for one zip per county.

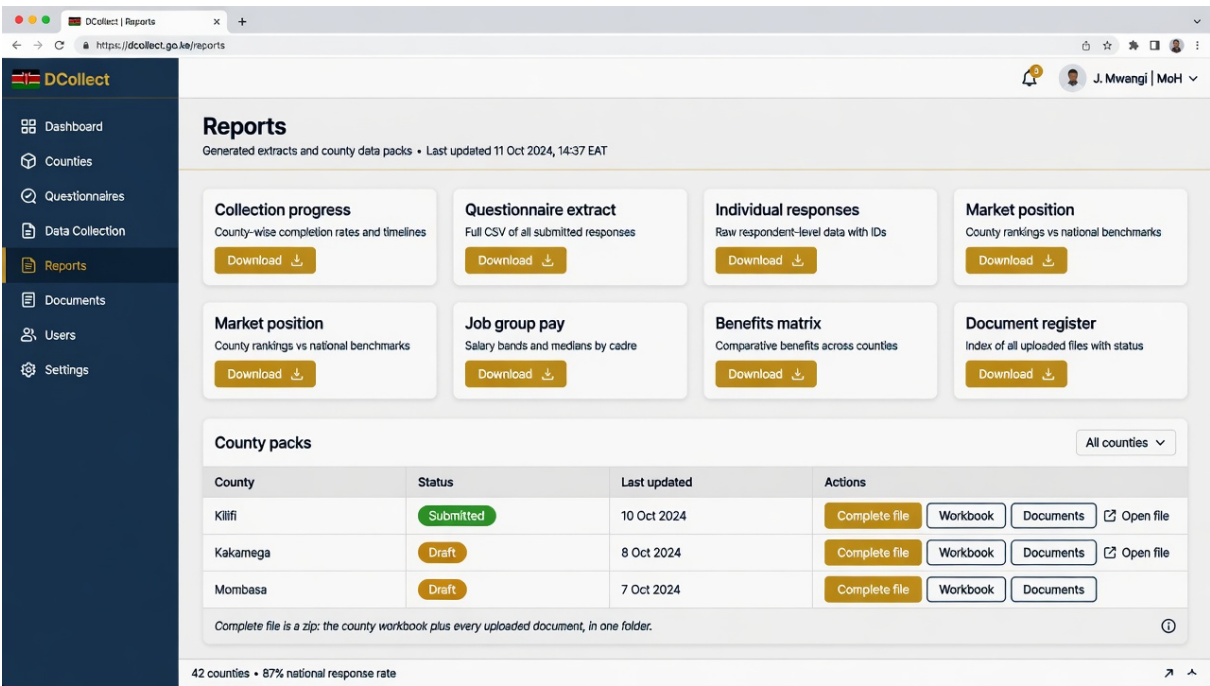


Figure 7. Reports centre — cross-county extracts and per-county Complete file / Workbook / Documents.

9.3 Complete county file (zip)

From Overview, Documents, Reports or County files, **Download complete file** produces one zip you can unzip and review as a folder:

- **README.txt** — county, period, status, headings marked not available or still empty.
- **County-submission.xlsx** — questionnaire, jobs, staff responses, benefits, document checklist, validation; reviewers also receive comparator and market sheets.
- **Supporting-documents/** — one sub-folder per document heading, with every uploaded file.

Workbook only is the Excel pack. Documents only is the attachments. The market workbook is all counties at once. County respondents who download a pack of their own file do not receive comparator or market sheets unless Analysis is switched on for counties.

10. Administrator setup, users, audit and data

Counties cannot start until an active period exists, files are opened, and county logins exist. Platform administrators also download this PDF from the left menu: **User manual (PDF)**.

10.1 Recommended setup order

- 1 **Variables & settings** — survey title, support email, confidentiality text, maximum upload size, active period, whether certification is required before submit, whether county users may open live Analysis.
- 2 **Survey periods** — one period is active at a time. Dashboards and reports use the active period.
- 3 **Catalogues** — counties, job families, job groups, SRC grades, benchmark jobs, benefit types, document types, validation items, comparator organisations. Inactive items are hidden from new work.
- 4 **Forms & questions** — mark required questionnaire items, jobs, benefits and documents. Add extra questions. Use Place after to sit a new question between two existing ones. Built-in questions can be reworded; they cannot be deleted.
- 5 **Dropdown lists** (Catalogues) — Yes/No, medical insurance, medical cover arrangement, internal equity, affordability, and the rest.
- 6 **Users** — one county respondent per county, or **Create missing county logins**. Add consultants and analysts. Only a platform administrator can create another administrator.
- 7 **Open county files** — Variables & settings or County files: select counties or open every county. Safe to repeat; existing files are not overwritten.
- 8 Assign a consultant on a file's Overview if that person should own the review.
- 9 **Staff survey links** — copy county URLs.

10.2 Form rules that affect submit

- bullet Require certification before submit — county must complete Certify first (default on).
- bullet Require complete to submit — county cannot submit while items marked Required are incomplete. Overview percentages still count every active question, job group, benefit and document.
- bullet Jobs require SRC equivalent — each applicable job-group row must have SRC text.

10.3 Users

A county login must be linked to exactly one county. Deleting a login under Users does not remove answers they already entered; audit rows stay under the username.

10.4 Audit trail (platform administrator only)

Left menu → **Audit trail**. Filter by search, role, area, county, outcome and dates. Download CSV. Events include sign-in, failed sign-in, sign-out, idle timeout, user administration, catalogue changes, county file saves, downloads (including complete file and this manual), and data purge. Passwords are never stored.

10.5 Data administration (platform administrator only)

Delete collected data for one county or one user, or reset all collected answers. Catalogues and logins stay unless you delete a login under Users. Type the confirmation name exactly. This cannot be undone.

11. Installing or updating DCollect

11.1 Fresh machine (no existing database)

Windows: unzip, double-click run.bat, choose 1 (local test) or 2 (production).

Linux / macOS: unzip, then **chmod +x run.sh** and **./run.sh** (choose 2 for production) or **./run.sh production**.

First run creates .venv, .env, applies migrations, loads catalogues and starter accounts. After production start, edit .env: `DEBUG=false`, `ALLOWED_HOSTS` and `CSRF_TRUSTED_ORIGINS` (include `https://collect.internetcongress.org` if that is the public URL). Restart. Change every starter password at first sign-in.

11.2 Updating the live site

Copy new application files over the current project. **Do not replace** db.sqlite3, .env, .venv or media. Then run migrate and collectstatic with the existing virtual environment, and restart. Do not run run.sh, run.bat or bootstrap on the live server. See DEPLOY.txt in the share pack.

12. If something will not work

- bullet After submit, the county file is locked. The county can edit again only in sections where a clarification was requested (or the whole file if all clarifications are answered).
- bullet At county login cannot open another county's file.
- bullet Jobs, benefits or document types added in settings appear the next time that file is opened.
- bullet If you cannot sign in, contact the person who issued the account.
- bullet You are signed out after 10 minutes without activity. Sign in again. After timeout you are returned to the page you were on when possible.
- bullet If a dropdown has no options, an administrator should attach a list under Setup → Catalogues → Dropdowns.
- bullet If a download fails, try again or use Documents to take files one by one. Uploaded files are not available as raw public /media/ links.
- bullet Overview at 100% on an empty file means an old version; this release counts actual answers and uploads.

12.1 Support

In-application: left menu → **What I need to do** (not shown to collection administrators). Platform administrators: left menu → **User manual (PDF)** for this document. Use the support email set under Variables & settings.

— End of manual —